

Live@ EBAday 2026

News Stocks TV Research Events

APIs

/ payments / markets / retail / wholesale / wealth / regulation / crime / c

Home Community Alexandre Kech **Organizational Identity ...**

Your feed

Groups

Organizational Identity Is the Layer Global Trade Has Been Missing

22 hours [Be the first to comment](#)



Alexandre Kech

CEO
The Global LEI Foundation

Location	Followers	Opinions
Zug	2	11

Follow

counterparties without being re-verified at every step. That is an organizational identity problem, and solving it is where the next phase of trade digitalization will be decided.

26,282

Expert opinions

41,089

Total members

Join

Sign in

But paperless is not the same as digital. Replacing a paper bill of lading with a PDF does not actually digitalize a process if someone must then manually rekey that data into the next system or rerun due diligence on a counterparty that another platform has already verified.

This means that scalable digital trade will not be realized by digitizing more documents. Rather, trusted data must move seamlessly across organizations, platforms, and jurisdictions. As outlined in a report from the ICC Digital Standards Initiative (DSI), this requires an interoperability layer comprising globally recognized standards, protocols, and identifiers.

Key to this interoperability layer is portable, verifiable organizational identity, which is to digital trade what container shipping was to physical trade. The container did not make ships faster. It standardized what moved between them, so a box could pass from truck to crane to vessel to customs without being unpacked and re-inspected at every handover. Trusted organizational identity does the same for data, enabling it to move across platforms and borders and allowing users to act on it directly without repeating checks.

Why interoperable organizational identity has been the missing piece

The need for globally standardized organizational identifiers stems from the fact that most identity schemes were built for domestic or closed systems. National IDs, electronic IDs, and platform-specific credentials work well within their own environments but are not easily recognized across borders or platforms without bespoke bilateral arrangements. Every time two parties who have never transacted have to establish trust from scratch, the friction returns.

Welcome to Finextra. We use cookies to help us to deliver our services. You may change your preferences at our [Cookie Centre](#).

Please read our [Privacy Policy](#).

Accept

own terms. The importer's bank checks the exporter. The carrier's platform verifies the freight forwarder. Customs validates the documentation against its own records. The same organizations are identified and re-identified at nearly every handover, because each system trusts only what it has checked itself. Every one of those checks is a place where the transaction can stall.

As trade becomes more data-driven, trust can no longer sit outside the transaction and must travel with the data. This is why the Legal Entity Identifier (LEI) and the verifiable LEI (vLEI) are increasingly being seen as foundational infrastructure. The LEI is a globally recognized identifier for the legal entity behind a transaction, already embedded in regulatory reporting across more than 100 jurisdictions, making it a common reference point for institutions in different countries. The vLEI extends this into digital interactions, enabling counterparties to computationally verify the identity, authority, and role of the people acting on behalf of an organization, while providing a foundation for emerging use cases such as AI agents.

Let's now revisit the earlier scenario and equip each organization with a verifiable identity that travels with the data. The freight forwarder does not need to re-establish the issuing bank's identity because the bank's identity and the authority of the person or agent who signed on its behalf can be verified directly against a common root of trust. The data stays at its source. All other authorized parties can then access and verify it in place rather than rekeying it or repeating the diligence behind it. The result is fewer manual checks, fewer reconciliations, and faster release of both goods and financing.

Trust is what turns digitization into automation

The reason organizational identity is so powerful is that it provides the underlying trust that bridges digitization and automation, where the actual benefits of digital trade lie. Structured data tells a system what is happening. Identity tells it who is acting and whether that action can be trusted.

Without trusted identity, every process still needs manual intervention, validation, and reconciliation. With it, systems can act with far more confidence. For instance, the faster an incoming instruction can be trusted, the faster liquidity is unlocked and

same logic that has long governed trusted messaging in payments, now applied to trade.

This presents an immediate, practical takeaway for anyone running trade operations at a bank or a platform. The first question worth asking is where, in existing flows, the same organizations are re-verified after they have already been onboarded, and what it would take to consume a verifiable identity instead of repeating that work. For firms that already hold an LEI, the question is whether it is being used for more than regulatory reporting. The standards are evolving, and the advantage will go to participants ready to consume portable identity when their counterparties begin presenting it.

Why increasing coordination is the key to unlocking global digital trade

Given that the tools exist and the economic incentives are compelling, the obvious question is why portable identity is not already standard across global trade ecosystems. This was the starting point for the ICC Digital Standards Initiative (DSI) paper, which outlined a roadmap for interoperability and trust across the trade ecosystem and identified uneven progress and priorities among different parties as a key limiting factor.

There are various reasons for this lack of alignment. Some platforms remain closed and treat interoperability as a competitive threat rather than something to embrace, because their advantage today comes from holding participants inside their own walls. There is also genuine – and understandable – apprehension about moving trust across networks, as relying on a verification someone else performed requires high confidence in how it was done. Finally, many micro, small, and medium-sized enterprises (MSMEs), particularly in emerging markets, lack the resources to invest in new infrastructure, unlike large corporates that can absorb the complexity.

All these problems are eminently solvable through more coordinated execution. There are clear roadmaps to help align policymakers and practitioners, make trust reusable rather than having to be recreated, and lower the cost of participation for the smallest players. For example, GLEIF's work to make organizational identity more accessible at the MSME level directly addresses this final challenge.

Share

Channels

[/identity](#)

Comments: (0)

Sign in to comment



Alexandre Kech

CEO

The Global LEI Foundation

Follow

Member since	Location	Followers	Following	Opinions
20 Nov 2024	Zug	2	1	11

Why Digital Finance Needs Connected Standards, Not More Identifiers

23 June

Who Stands Behind the Document? Why Digital Data Needs Verifiable Organizational Identity

14 May

What Post-Trade Infrastructure Really Needs to Be Ready for T Plus 1

21 April

How the LEI and vLEI Can Advance Global Digital Asset Oversight

13 April

[See all Opinions from Alexandre](#)

More expert opinions



Alex Kreger Founder and CEO at UXDA Financial UX Agency

AI Will Soon Generate Thousands of Financial Apps in Minutes, But That Won't Be Enough

12 hours

6

8



Luigi Wewege President at Caye International Bank

Future of International Banking: Why Trust, Tech and Global Diversification Matter More Than Ever

16 hours



Vugar Usi CEO at MEXC

Beyond Crypto: Why Global Market Access Is Becoming the Product

18 hours



Priya Lakshmi Founder at AISSURED

From Hire to Retire - Governing AI Employees: Part 3 – Training

19 hours

[See all opinions](#)

Finextra®

Finextra

About

Get involved

Finextra Live@

Welcome to Finextra. We use cookies to help us to deliver our services. You may change your preferences at our [Cookie Centre](#).

Please read our [Privacy Policy](#).

Accept

Contact the community team

Research

Finextra.jobs

Finextra Pro

News

Guidance

Contact the news desk

Sales

Media pack

Contact the sales team

Events

Sustainable Finance Live

NextGen Nordics

EBAday

Members

Join the community

News alerts

Follow



Add Finextra as a preferred source on Google

Download Finextra Pro

Discover **Finextra** PRO

Download Finextra News



© Finextra Research 2026

[Terms of use](#) [Privacy Policy](#) [Cookie Centre](#)

Welcome to Finextra. We use cookies to help us to deliver our services. You may change your preferences at our [Cookie Centre](#).

Please read our [Privacy Policy](#).

Accept